PART II · TIME · 3

How long is a note?

Need a note longer than its shape allows? Two signs stretch it: the **dot**, which adds half, and the **tie**, which glues two notes into one sound.

THE SECRET
A dot adds half. A tie glues two notes into one.
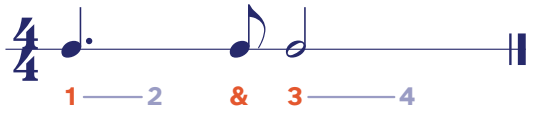


2 beats **2 + 1 = 3 beats**

The dot adds half

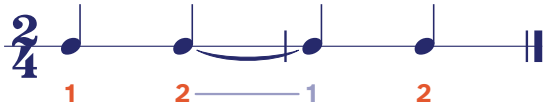
The dot

A dot adds **half the note's value**: a dotted minim lasts 2 + 1 = 3 beats; a dotted crotchet 1 + ½ = 1½.



The tie

A curve joining two notes **of the same pitch** makes one longer sound: play the first, hold through the second. Ties can cross a bar line, where a dot cannot.



The dot, in pizzas

The dot is a helper that adds **half of whatever its note is worth**. Dark slices: the note. Lighter: what the dot adds.

dotted minim		2 + **1** (half of 2) = **3 beats**
dotted crotchet		1 + **½** (half of 1) = **1½ beats**
dotted quaver		½ + **¼** (half of ½) = **¾ beat**
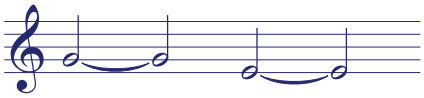
EXTRA · GOING FURTHER

The double dot

A second dot adds half of the first dot: a double-dotted minim lasts 2 + 1 + ½ = **3½ beats**. Rare before the higher Levels.

PART II · TIME · 3 · CONTINUED

Tie or slur?



Tie: the same pitch. Play once and hold: G for 4 beats, then E for 4.



Slur: different pitches. Play every note, smoothly joined (legato).

TWO-MINUTE DRILL Clap a dotted minim ("1 2 3"), a dotted crotchet and quaver ("1 & 2 &": clap on 1 and on the last &), then two tied crotchets ("1 2"). Say the counts aloud and never re-clap a tied note.

EXAMPLE 1

Dot or tie: which is longer?
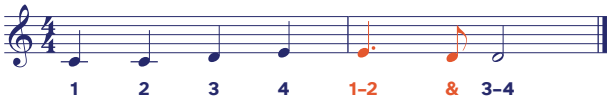


1. **The dotted minim:** a dot adds half. How many beats?
2. **The tied notes:** add the two notes together.
3. **Compare** the two totals.

Both last **3 beats**: the same length. A tie can also cross a bar line, which a dot cannot.

EXAMPLE 2

A dotted crotchet you already know: Ode to Joy



1. **Bars 3–4 of Beethoven's Ode to Joy.** Sing it: "C C D E, E — D D".
2. **The red E is a dotted crotchet:** 1 + ½ = 1½ beats, held through "1 & 2".
3. **The quaver D** falls on the "&" of beat 2; the last D takes beats 3 and 4.

Long–short, then long: the dot is why the tune **leans** before it lands.

EXAMPLE 3

Which is longer: a dotted minim or a minim tied to a quaver?



1. **Dotted minim:** add half of 2. How many pizzas?
2. **Minim tied to a quaver:** add the two.
3. **Compare** the totals.

3 against 2½: the **dotted minim** is longer, by half a beat.

PART II · TIME · 3 · CONTINUED

GAME

How many beats?



1 2 3

With a crotchet as one beat: how long does each one last?

Answer: 1 three (2 + 1) · 2 one and a half (1 + ½) · 3 three (2 tied to 1).

TRY IT · 10 SECONDS

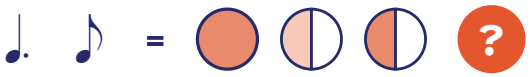


Clap once, hold for three.

Say “1 2 3” as you hold: a dotted minim. Then a dotted crotchet and quaver: “1 (& 2) &”.

EXAMPLE 4

How many beats: a dotted crotchet and a quaver?

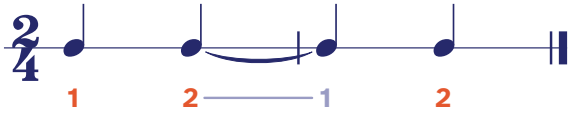


1. **The dotted crotchet:** 1 beat plus half of 1.
2. **The quaver:** half a beat.
3. **Add them.** Where does the quaver fall?

1½ + ½ = **2 beats**. The quaver lands on the “&” of beat 2: “1 (&) 2 **&**”.

EXAMPLE 5

How long do you hold a tie?



1. **Play the first note** and count its beats.
2. **Keep holding** through the tie. Do you play the second note again?
3. **Add the beats** of both notes.

One sound, never played twice: a tie **adds the beats** of both notes. Here: 2 beats.

TRAP

- × Putting the dot on the wrong note: a dot adds half of **its own** note.
- × Tying two different pitches: that curve is a slur, not a tie.
- × Two dots: **after** the head adds length; **above or below** it means staccato.

SEE ALSO

Time signatures p. 59 · Rhythm p. 65

PRACTISE IT

Workbook Level 0 · Note values · Online: Library